

JAMES RICHARDSON

Backend Engineer | Staff Level

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Location: Birmingham, United Kingdom

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a backend engineer with 14 years of experience building scalable systems and leading technical teams through complex architectural decisions. I've spent the last decade working on high-traffic microservices platforms handling millions of daily transactions. I'm most comfortable with Python and Go, and I genuinely enjoy mentoring junior engineers through design problems and code reviews.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Java, SQL, JavaScript, Bash

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, MongoDB, DynamoDB

Cloud Platforms: AWS, GCP, Docker, Kubernetes

Message Queues: RabbitMQ, Kafka, SQS

Tools and Frameworks: Django, FastAPI, gRPC, GraphQL, Elasticsearch

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Methodologies: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, CI/CD, Test-Driven Development

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Backend Engineer

Vertex Systems

vertex-systems.io

Birmingham, United Kingdom

January 2021 - Present

Led the redesign of our order processing platform from monolith to microservices, reducing latency by 62% and enabling the team to scale to handle 10 million daily transactions without infrastructure bloat.

Established engineering standards across backend teams including code review processes, testing requirements, and deployment procedures that improved bug detection rates by 45% in the first six months.

Mentored five junior engineers through their first two years of employment, with all five promoted within three years of joining the team.

Architected and implemented a custom rate limiting service in Go that serves as the foundation for all API traffic management, currently protecting twelve different product lines.

Senior Backend Engineer

DataFlow Solutions Ltd

dataflow-solutions.net

Coventry, United Kingdom

June 2016 - December 2020

Built and maintained a real-time analytics pipeline processing 500GB of data daily across 15 interconnected microservices using Kafka and PostgreSQL.

Reduced database query times by 70% through strategic indexing and query optimization work, directly improving user experience for our analytics dashboard.

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting infrastructure using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing mean time to detection for production incidents from 45 minutes to 8 minutes.

Conducted regular technical interviews and helped grow the backend team from four to twelve engineers over a three year period.

Backend Engineer

Clearstone Digital

clearstone-digital.co

Bristol, United Kingdom

July 2010 - May 2016

Developed and deployed RESTful APIs serving mobile and web applications using Python Django, with a focus on clean code and comprehensive unit testing.

Migrated legacy database schema to a modern PostgreSQL design with zero downtime, completing the project on schedule while maintaining service availability.

Worked on payment processing systems handling over £50 million in annual transactions with PCI compliance requirements.

Collaborated with product and frontend teams to design data models and API contracts that balanced technical requirements with business constraints.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Birmingham

Birmingham, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2010

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional

Issued: March 2019